

Massachusetts Cultural Resource Information System

Scanned Record Cover Page

Inventory No:	EBR.27
Historic Name:	Gurney, Henry House
Common Name:	Reniff, John - Smith, Henry T. House
Address:	843 North Bedford St
City/Town:	East Bridgewater
Village/Neighborhood:	
Local No:	
Year Constructed:	1794
Architectural Style(s):	Federal;
Use(s):	Agricultural; Single Family Dwelling House;
Significance:	Agriculture; Architecture;
Area(s):	
Designation(s):	
Building Materials:	Roof: Asphalt Shingle; Wall: Wood; Wood Clapboard; Foundation: Granite; Stone, Cut;
Demolished	No



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Commonwealth of Massachusetts
Massachusetts Historical Commission
220 Morrissey Boulevard, Boston, Massachusetts 02125
www.sec.state.ma.us/mhc

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FORM B - BUILDING

MASSACHUSETTS HISTORICAL COMMISSION
Office of the Secretary, State House, Boston

In Area no.

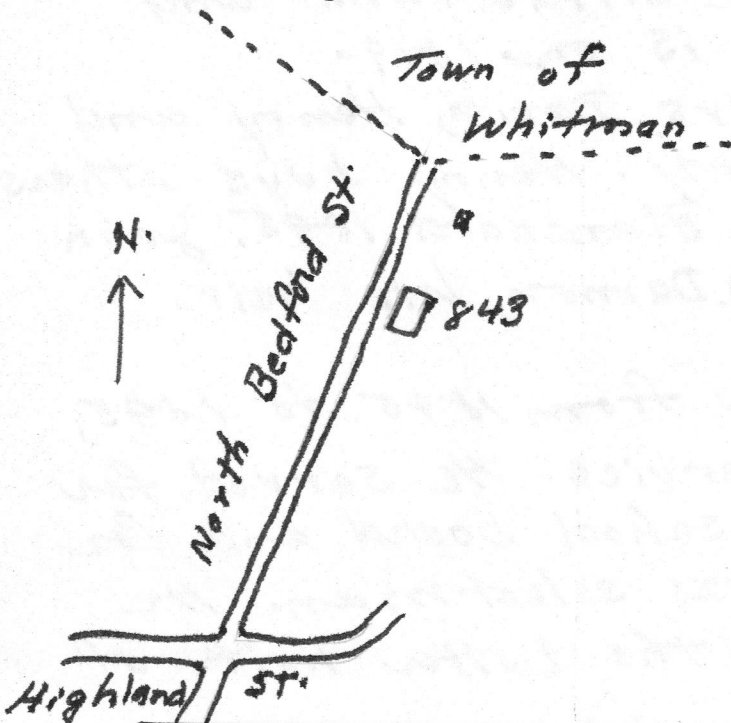
Form no.

27

XV-7



1. Map. Draw sketch of building location in relation to nearest cross streets and other buildings. Indicate north.

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS SPACE
USGS Quadrant _____

MHC Photo no. _____

RECEIVED

Last house before Whitman
Line(over)
MAR 31 1977

MASS. HIST. COMM.

Town East BridgewaterAddress 843 N. Bedford St.Name Henry GurneyPresent use HomePresent owner Robin D. Brittain

Description:

Date 1794Source DeedsStyle Cape Cod Cottage

Architect _____

Exterior wall fabric ClapboardsOutbuildings (describe) BarnOther features 4 chimneys,1 original. 2 ellsRoof is boarded vertically

Altered _____ Date _____

Moved _____ Date _____

5. Lot size:

One acre or less _____ Over one acre ☒Approximate frontage 2200'

Approximate distance of building from street

20'6. Recorded by Edna L. WhitmoreOrganization E.B. Hist. Com.Date Aug. 14, 1976

7. Original owner (if known) John Reniff (part of original
 Original use Farm land grant of John Edson)

Subsequent uses (if any) and dates _____

8. Themes (check as many as applicable)

Aboriginal _____	Conservation _____	Recreation _____
Agricultural ☒	Education _____	Religion _____
Architectural ☒	Exploration/ settlement _____	Science/ invention _____
The Arts _____	Industry _____	Social/ humanitarian _____
Commerce _____	Military _____	Transportation _____
Communication _____	Political ☒	
Community development ☒		

9. Historical significance (include explanation of themes checked above)

Owners. John Reniff 1794. Henry T. Smith 1794
 Bela Reed 1795. John Bisbee 1796. Zeba & Chandler
 Bisbee, heirs of John Bisbee divide land and
 Zeba receives land house is on 1819.

Seth Gurney 1824. 3 heirs, David, Henry and
 Emily Gurney divide property. Henry buys others
 shares 1845. William J. Blanchard 1895. John
 P. Damon 1907. Warren A. Damon, his heir.
 Robin D. Brittain 1954

Henry Gurney, owner from 1845 to 1895,
 was active in public service. He served for
 several years on the school board and for
 twenty-five years he was selectman. He
 served as chairman for the better half of
 those years.

10. Bibliography and/or references (such as local histories, deeds, assessor's records, early maps, etc.)